

Our topic today is the dualist view that we are (either wholly or in part) immaterial things.

You may recall that we came up with two dualist answers to
the identity question:

A large blue circle with a white drop shadow, containing white text.

**Simple
dualism: I am
an immaterial
soul**

A solid blue circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is centered and reads: "Fusion dualism: I am a combination of a soul and a body".

Fusion
dualism: I am
a combination
of a soul
and a body

**Soul
survival:**

X is me just in
case X is the
same immaterial
soul as me

**Fusion
survival:**

X is me just in case X
has the same immaterial
soul as me and is the
same material thing as
me

For right now we're going to set aside the question of which of these views is better.

Instead, we're going to ask a more fundamental question: is there any good reason to believe in the existence of immaterial souls?

1. We have no sensory experience of immaterial souls.
2. It is not self-evident that there are immaterial souls.
3. We have no good argument for the existence of immaterial souls.
4. If P is not self-evident and your senses don't tell you that P and you don't have a good argument for P, you should not believe P.

You should not believe in the
existence of immaterial souls.
(1,2,3,4)

THE EVIDENTIALIST ARGUMENT AGAINST BELIEF IN IMMATERIAL SOULS

This might be called the 'evidentialist' argument against belief in immaterial souls, since it is based on the idea that we have no **evidence** for the existence of immaterial souls.

When we turn to the question of how we should determine what to believe, we'll ask whether 'rules of belief' like premise (4) are true. But the premise looks at least initially plausible; so it puts some pressure on the believer in immaterial souls to respond to the argument by rejecting premise (3).

But then we need an argument for the
existence of immaterial souls.

We'll come back to the question of whether there is any such argument next time.

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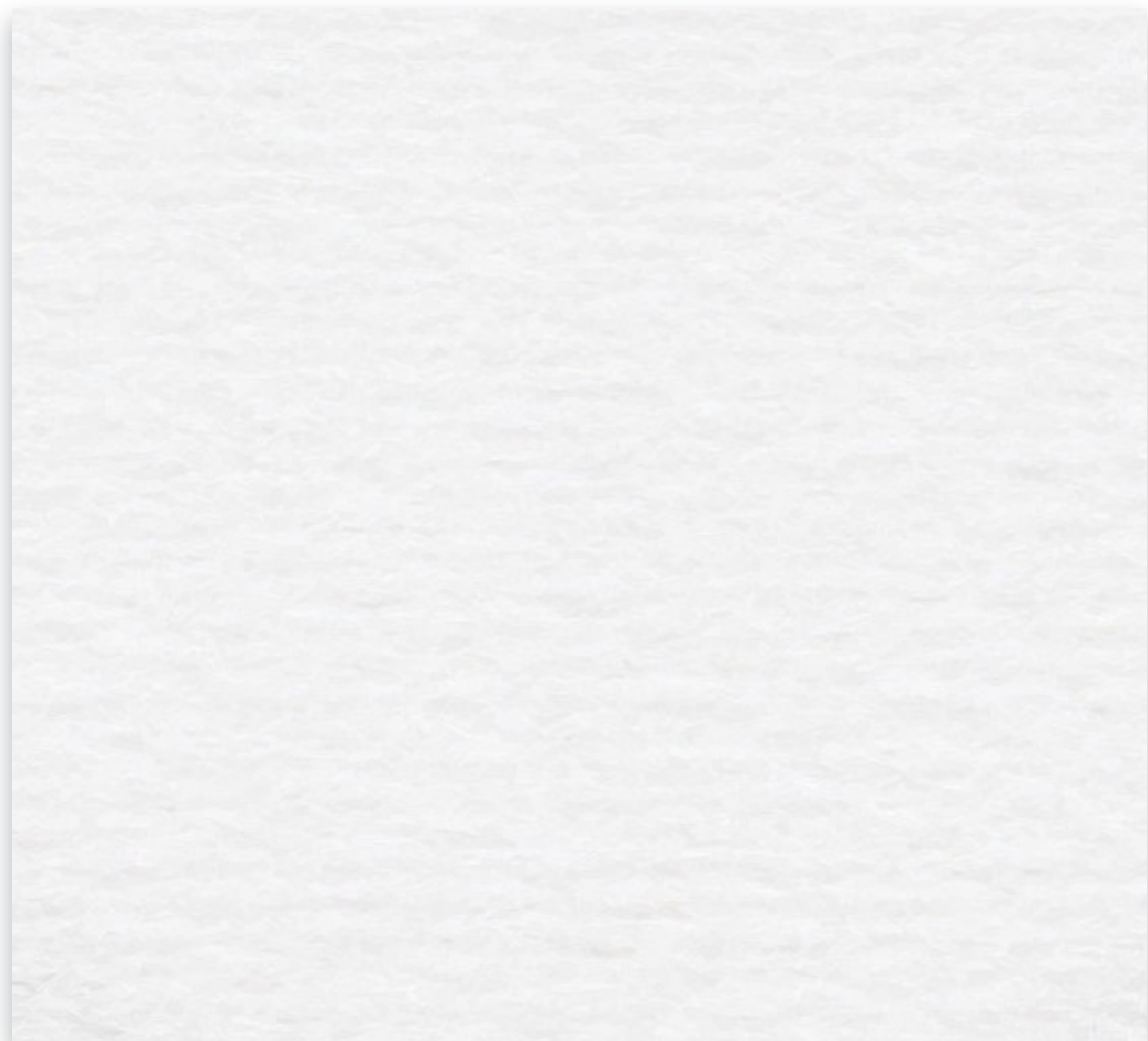
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in materials?

there any good reason to believe in the existence of



You should not believe in the

there are infants:

argument for P , you should not

the experience in Atlanta



And you don't have a good

your senses don't tell you that

4. If P is not self-evident and

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SQLS.

do i i e v e .

existentialism.

3. We have no good argument for

(1, 2, 3, 4)

2. It is not self-evident that

1. We have no sensory experience



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argument against belief in immaterial

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We'll come back to the question of

example.

Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to



Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in

this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I have that photo, and

show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact about which one is

It is very natural to assume that these questions must have determinate answers.

There must be some fact of the matter about whether or not the people in the photo

you.

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be



in this picture, and must be a fact about which the survivors are

Then we can ask a question about these facts:



useful to think about simple, universal example of survival.

To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put

the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now

sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person

who will wake up in bed tomorrow.

What do we mean when we say that you are identical to that person?

attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

This is the distinction between numerical and qualitative identity.

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not

same thing — they are one, not two.

Today that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they

exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed

to morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively

identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing

different identities.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow in that bed.

But then we can ask the survival question: in virtue of what are you numerical

the same person as the person who will wake up in that bed?



But this is not the only answer to our question. It is a

also have innovative materials.

widely held view that we are not simply material beings, but

If one believes in immaterial souls, then it is natural to think

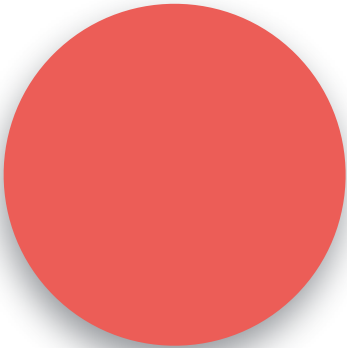
existence in material soul.

that one's survival is closely linked to the continued

This suggests an alternative theory of survival. On this view,

the person who wakes up in that bed tomorrow is you

because they are, or have, the same immaterial soul.



physical connections, and not be afraid of anything involving

But these are not the only possible views here. One might

immaterial souls, but rather because psychological

connections between you and that person.

also hold that you are that person not because of any

Which psychological connections? One popular approach

focus on memories. On this view, the thing which makes

bedtime is your shared memories.

you the same person as the person who will wake up in that

personalities.

have very similar beliefs and desires, and very similar

Of course there are plenty of other psychological

connections you will have to that person as well. You will

Let's call the idea that you are the same person because of

you're psychologically disconnected psychologically survival.

It is worth pausing to think about the difference between the soul

theory and the psychological theory of survival. At a first glance,

they can look like the same thing. But they are not.

'mind.' But remember that in the present context a soul is an

In ordinary language, 'soul' is sometimes used as a synonym for

material thing which is closely connected to your identity.